

Smart Link Manager & Attribution System

What We Need to Build It — and What Is Not Possible

Version 1.0 | 10 September 2026 | Companion to the PRD, TRD, Backend Schema and UI/UX Handoff (all v1.0, 9 September 2026)

This document answers two questions in plain terms: what has to be provided before the system can be built, and what the system will never be able to do no matter how well it is built. The second list matters as much as the first — it sets expectations before development money is spent, rather than after the first report is delivered.

Note on sources. Most points below restate requirements already written into the four project documents. A small number are practical limits of the advertising and browser ecosystem that the documents do not mention; those are marked **ADDED** so you can see exactly what is quoted policy and what is engineering judgement.

1 What we need

ACCESS AND ACCOUNTS

What	Who provides it	What breaks without it
DNS control over betindia.bet, to point go.betindia.bet at our server	Domain owner	No tracking links can exist at all. This is the first blocker.
A server running Node and PostgreSQL, hosted close to India	BetIndia infrastructure owner	Nothing can be hosted. Region affects the sub-300ms redirect target in TRD §15.
Deploy access to the BetIndia website	Website / web team	No website tracking and no click ID carried into the registration form. The website funnel cannot be measured.
Interakt account with webhook access and a test number	BetIndia marketing	No WhatsApp lead measurement of any kind.
Login to each publisher's reporting panel	Partnerships	No impressions or spend figures, so no reconciliation and no true cost per result.

FROM THE BETTING PLATFORM

What	Who provides it	What breaks without it
Registration API or webhook	Platform owner or white-label vendor	The funnel stops at "lead". No registration counts, no click-to-registration rate.
Transaction / deposit API	Platform owner or white-label vendor	No FTD data. Cost per FTD — the number the whole system exists to produce — cannot be calculated.
Written definition of a genuine first deposit	Finance, with the platform	FTD figures cannot be agreed or audited. Required by PRD §8 and TRD §9.

PUBLISHER APPROVALS — NEEDED IN WRITING, PER PUBLISHER

What	Who provides it	What breaks without it
Confirmation that our tracking URL is permitted	Each publisher	The campaign cannot run on that publisher at all.
Which click macros they support	Each publisher	No publisher click ID to reconcile against, so click discrepancies cannot be investigated.
Whether a WhatsApp destination is allowed	Each publisher	WhatsApp campaigns are blocked on that inventory.
Rules for changing a destination after approval	Each publisher	Risk of breaching the approval. TRD §13 permits only what is explicitly approved.

DECISIONS FROM THE BUSINESS

What	Who decides	What breaks without it
Attribution model and lookback window — the proposal is first click, 30 days	Whoever pays the publishers	Reports cannot be finalised and publisher payouts will be disputed. TRD §10 marks this "subject to business approval".
What makes one unique lead	Business	Repeat messages inflate lead counts and every downstream ratio is wrong.
Data retention and consent policy, plus Indian legal review	Legal	The system cannot go to production. Required by PRD §13 and TRD §14.

ONE TEST THAT SHOULD BE RUN BEFORE ANYTHING IS BUILT

Does a campaign code survive from a WhatsApp prefilled message into Interakt's incoming webhook? This takes about a day with a trial account. The answer decides whether WhatsApp attribution is exact, campaign-level, or unknown — and therefore what the dashboard is permitted to claim. Every one of the four documents flags this as unverified and instructs that it be tested rather than assumed.

2 What is not possible

These are ceilings, not bugs. No amount of budget or engineering removes them, and they apply equally to any competing tracking platform.

Click-level WhatsApp attribution

When a link opens WhatsApp, the click ID does not travel with it. WhatsApp does not report which banner a person came from. The only available mechanism is a campaign code inside the prefilled message — and the user can delete that text before sending.

Consequence: WhatsApp attribution is campaign-level at best, with leakage. Per-click matching should not be promised to anyone.

Cross-device journeys

A person who clicks on their phone and registers on a laptop breaks the chain. There is no way to reconnect the two without a login identity that spans both devices.

Consequence: A share of genuine conversions will land in the unknown bucket. TRD §10 requires these limits be documented before launch.

True unique-person counts

A click is an event, not a human. The same person on two devices counts as two. This is stated directly in PRD §5.

Consequence: "Unique visitors" is always a deduplicated estimate and must be labelled as one.

A full 30-day window on iPhone and inside publisher apps ADDED

Safari deletes script-set first-party cookies after seven days. Publisher apps open links in their own in-app browser, where storage often does not carry over to the user's real browser at all.

Consequence: The 30-day lookback works on paper and partly in practice. Expect a meaningful share of iOS and in-app traffic to fall out of the window. Server-side session association reduces this but does not eliminate it.

Our own impression counts

Impressions happen on the publisher's page, where we have no presence. Only the publisher can count them.

Consequence: Impressions are always an imported figure supplied by the publisher, never a measured one.

An exact match with publisher click numbers

Publisher counts and our counts will never agree. Different bot filtering, different timezones, different definitions of a valid click, and clicks lost before the redirect completes.

Consequence: A permanent gap, commonly in the range of five to twenty percent ADDED. Agree in advance whose number is used for billing.

A confirmed "WhatsApp opened" event

We can record that we issued a redirect. Whether the app actually opened is invisible to us unless an observable event exists.

Consequence: PRD §6 requires redirect clicks be reported as a separate proxy metric, not as opens.

One hundred percent attribution

There will always be conversions that cannot be traced to a click.

Consequence: An unknown bucket is permanent. TRD §10 forbids spreading it across campaigns to make reports look complete.

Any history before launch day

The system can only measure traffic that passes through its own links.

Consequence: Reporting starts at zero. Past campaign performance cannot be reconstructed.

Registration and FTD data without platform cooperation

This half of the funnel lives inside the betting platform. We can only receive what it is willing to send.

Consequence: If no API is granted, the fallback is a manual CSV upload of registrations and deposits matched on phone number **ADDED** — workable, but slower and at lower matching confidence, and Backend Schema §4 warns that a phone number alone is not proof of a click.

3 What the system will actually tell you

With everything in place, you get

- + Clicks by publisher, placement, creative, device and date — measured first-hand, not reported by the publisher
- + True cost per click, per lead, per registration and per FTD
- + A solid click → registration → FTD chain on the website path
- + Counts of real WhatsApp conversations, campaign-attributed
- + Reconciliation showing where publisher numbers disagree with ours
- + An auditable record of every destination change and approval

You will not get

- A clean person-by-person journey from banner to deposit
- Per-click attribution for WhatsApp leads
- Conversions that crossed devices
- Numbers that exactly match what publishers report
- A report with no unknown bucket in it
- Any data about campaigns that ran before launch

Items marked **ADDED** are practical platform limits not stated in the project documents; everything else restates requirements already written into the PRD, TRD, Backend Database Schema or UI/UX Developer Handoff. Section references point to those documents. Figures given as ranges are industry-typical expectations, not measured results for this project.